Loro

A free, privacy-first Spanish practice site with teacher assignments, a gradebook, and weak-spot tracking.

Built by Eva Krasner, 10th grade
spanishstudysite.github.io
(formerly Spanish Study Hub)

WHAT'S NEW SINCE THE LAST VERSION

- **New name and link:** now called Loro, and moved from Netlify to GitHub Pages, which has no usage credits to run out.
- **No student names at all:** students sign up with an animal username (like *koalaab3*) and a 4-digit PIN. Old named accounts were deleted.
- **Stronger teacher logins:** teachers use a real password, and a teacher code is needed to make an account.
- **Shared Chromebook safety:** students are logged out after 30 idle minutes (with a "Still there?" warning), and the login slows down after 5 wrong PINs.
- **Backups and alerts:** weekly encrypted backups and a daily error check (details below).
- **Loro the parrot** cheers students on during practice in English and Spanish.

WHAT IT IS

Students practice vocabulary and verb conjugations by typing, with accent buttons and instant feedback. Teachers build units from their own word lists and send assignments to a class: "practice 15 minutes," "complete 20 terms at 80%," or "answer 40 words in 8 minutes at 80%." Students turn work in, and the teacher sees it in a gradebook that copies into a spreadsheet. A **Weak spots** page shows which words each class misses most.

WHY I BUILT IT

I wanted a different way to study than the tools we were given, because they didn't match how I learn best. In **September** I built a first version for one test, then turned it into a place for all my study sets. Friends wanted to use it too, so in **October** I added classes, assignments, turn-in, a gradebook, and weak-spot reports. In **November** I rebuilt the logins so no student names are stored, and added safety and backup tools so a school can rely on it.



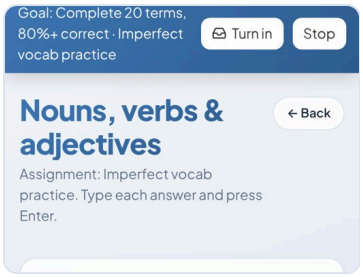
Teacher: assignments and progress



Gradebook (copies to Sheets)



Weak spots: what to reteach

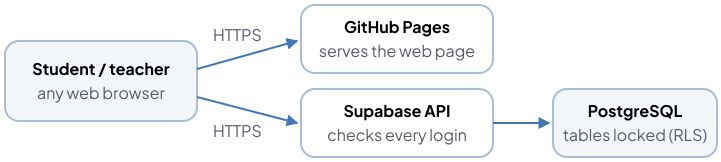


Student: typing an assignment

HOW A CLASS WOULD USE IT

1. **Teacher signs up** at the link with the department's teacher code and picks a password.
2. **Teacher makes a class** (for example, Spanish 2, Period 3) and gets a class code.
3. **Students join:** they enter the class code, pick an animal, and set a 4-digit PIN. No email, no Google account, no name.
4. **Teacher keeps a paper or gradebook list** of which animal is which student. That list never goes into Loro.
5. **Teacher sends assignments** with a goal and due date. Students practice in class or at home on any device.
6. **Teacher checks the gradebook and weak spots** and resets a PIN if a student forgets it.

WHERE IT'S HOSTED & HOW DATA IS HANDLED



- **The website** is one web page hosted free on **GitHub Pages**, GitHub's service for public sites, over HTTPS. There's nothing to install and no usage credits to run out.
- **The data** (usernames, scores, assignments) lives in a **Supabase** database (PostgreSQL). The browser can't read tables directly. Every request goes through server functions that check the login first, and teachers see only their own classes. PINs and passwords are stored only as bcrypt hashes.
- **Behind the scenes:** an encrypted backup of the database every week (kept 90 days), a daily error check that emails me if something breaks, a twice-weekly ping that keeps the free database awake, and 1,000+ automated checks that must pass before any update goes live.
- **Cost:** free on both services' free plans, with room for well over a thousand students. No analytics, ads, or tracking scripts.
- **Continuity:** the accounts and code can be handed to a teacher or the district, so it doesn't depend on me. Screenshots show sample data, not real students.

STUDENT DATA & SOPPA (ILLINOIS)

Stored	Not collected
Animal username, a 4-digit PIN stored only as a hash, class membership, practice scores and times, missed words	Names, email, birthdate, student ID, address, phone, photos, location, device IDs. No ads, no selling or sharing data.

Nothing in Loro can be traced back to a real student. Only the teacher's own offline list connects an animal to a person.

SOPPA requirement (as I understand it)	Status
No targeted ads, selling, or renting of student data	**Met**
Reasonable security for student data	**Met**
Delete student data when the school asks	**Met**

QUESTIONS ABOUT NEXT STEPS

I'd really appreciate your help understanding the process for a school to use something like this:

1. What approvals would Loro need before teachers use it with students, and who decides?
2. For SOPPA, is anything else needed from me, like a written agreement or forms, or does the district handle that?
3. Who is the right person to talk to about student data and approved websites?
4. Would trying it with one class first be possible, and what would that look like?
5. Is there anything you'd want me to change or add before it's ready?

KNOWN LIMITS

Logins are animal username + PIN, not school Google sign-in. That keeps student identities out entirely, but a forgotten PIN needs the teacher to reset it.